GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

March 20th, 2026
Week 12
Volume 282, Issue 1227

Highlights:

- **Eid hols.**
- **War ongoing.**
- **Recycling ruse.**
- **Sales slow.**
- **USD woes.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"Great works are performed not by strength but by perseverance."

–Samuel Johnson

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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EID PAUSE!

Eid al-Fitr has arrived to greet the world's ship recycling markets this week, and as is tradition, it came bearing the gift of silence. From Chattogram to Gadani, Alang to Aliağa, the holy festival has pressed pause on an industry that was already beginning to feel the compounding weight of war, currency volatility, and a stubborn absence of fresh tonnage offerings.

The backdrop to this year's Eid break is, to put it charitably, anything but restful. The ongoing conflict in the Middle East, which has now stretched into its third week following the U.S.-Israeli military campaign against Iran, continues to send tremors through global energy and freight markets in equal measure. Brent crude briefly pierced USD 119/barrel on Thursday following Iranian retaliatory strikes on Qatar's Ras Laffan LNG facility, before retreating to settle at USD 108.65/barrel after Netanyahu signalled Israel was helping reopen the Strait of Hormuz. The week's close above USD 100/barrel for the sixth consecutive session shows just how embedded this new price floor has become.

For ship recyclers, the arithmetic of this war continues to deliver perverse outcomes. Higher oil prices logically translate into higher freight earnings for trading vessels, which in turn means owners are less inclined to sell tonnage for recycling when their ageing units are suddenly pulling respectable income. The Baltic Dry Index closed at 2,057 today, down 7 points on the session but still firm relative to the sub-1,600 lows seen in January, another nail in the coffin for those hoping for a surge of demolition candidates before the monsoon season arrives in June.

The U.S. Dollar continued its reign across all ship recycling destination currencies this week. The Indian Rupee, Pakistani Rupee, Bangladeshi Taka, and Turkish Lira all weakened against the USD, adding inflationary pressure to domestic steel pricing that is already under strain from disrupted supply chains. For recyclers whose revenues are denominated in USD but whose cost bases run in local currency, this would ordinarily be welcome news. Instead, the combination of reduced tonnage supply and unsettled buyer sentiment has meant that the currency advantage has delivered little in the way of increased appetite.

If there is any comfort to be found this week, it is that the Eid holiday provides a natural pause during which yards in both Bangladesh and Pakistan can press forward on their Hong Kong Convention compliance upgrades. With the HKC now in force and inspections increasingly rigorous, any time away from active purchasing is time that can be redirected toward certification.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 12 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

PRICE ADVANTAGE!

Market leaders.

Bangladesh enters this Eid holiday in an unenviable position, leading the sub-continent price board, yet unable to convert that pricing leadership into meaningful transaction volume. The holiday has effectively shuttered negotiations for the week, with Chattogram's waterfront operating at ceremonial pace and no new arrivals of note reported as buyers observe the three-day festival.

Taka losing ground.

The Bangladeshi Taka continued to lose ground against the U.S. Dollar this week, slipping a further 8 basis points to close at BDT 122.26, its weakest level against the Dollar in 2026. For recyclers buying tonnage in dollars and selling recycled steel in Taka, this persistent currency erosion is a structural headache that holiday cheer does little to address. Local steel plate prices nudged upward marginally, finishing the week at approximately USD 511/ton, though this modest improvement was largely driven by supply anxiety rather than genuine demand strength, as the war's impact on regional steel flows continues to introduce unpredictability into procurement chains.

No OFAC.

The two OFAC-sanctioned VLCCs that have been idling at OPL Chattogram continue to attract considerable industry attention, though not of the productive variety. Neither vessel has yet received the No Objection Certificate required for entry into port limits, and the BSBRA has made clear it will not facilitate their delivery. The episode serves as a pointed reminder of the risks that some cash buyers appear willing to accept in pursuit of margin, and of the reputational damage that can flow to the wider market when international sanctions are visibly flouted at the anchorage.

Supply issues.

Looking ahead, the post-Eid period will be the true test. If Bangladesh can couple its pricing advantage with faster central bank approvals on Letters of Credit, a bottleneck that has frustrated Sellers and buyers alike for weeks, the market may yet see a modest pre-monsoon flurry of activity. The HKC certification pipeline at Chattogram is also progressing, with several yards now reportedly within weeks of completing their documentation. A cleaner, more compliant Bangladeshi market is on the horizon. Whether tonnage arrives in sufficient quantity to fill those upgraded yards before the June rains is the more pressing question.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

OBSERVANT!

Crises unfold.

Alang's yards observed Eid with a quiet that belied the underlying anxiety of the week. India's ship recycling community finds itself watching two crises unfold simultaneously, one external, one domestic, and neither is particularly conducive to bold purchasing decisions.

Gas shortage?

On the external front, the war in the Middle East has now directly disrupted India's two primary crude oil supply relationships. Iranian supplies are effectively suspended for the foreseeable future following the closure of Hormuz to unchaperoned transit, while Russian oil, already subject to the price cap architecture, faces fresh U.S. secondary sanctions pressure that has made Indian refiners increasingly cautious about their exposure. The practical result has been a sharp rise in the landed cost of energy across India's industrial base, with gas shortage rumours at Alang, though firmly denied by the BSBRA's Indian equivalent, adding a layer of operational uncertainty that recyclers could do without.

Rupee worries.

Domestically, the Indian Rupee extended its weakening trend against the U.S. Dollar, closing the week at approximately Rs. 92.40, a new low for 2026 and a level that has rattled sentiment among Alang's more cautious buyers. Local steel plate prices remained volatile, trading in a range between USD 418 and USD 422/ton through the week before settling at approximately USD 422/ton by Thursday. The intra-week swings, driven in part by speculation about steel scrap import disruption from war-affected regions, are making it difficult for Alang recyclers to set offer levels with any confidence, as the underlying cost basis shifts beneath their feet.

HKC gains.

The HKC picture at Alang remains India's strongest competitive asset. With the overwhelming majority of Alang yards now holding valid SoC certifications, India is uniquely positioned to receive compliant green tonnage from owners who are under regulatory pressure to demonstrate responsible end-of-life practices. Several such units are understood to be in the pipeline, though formal sales have not yet been announced.

Alang's anchorage remains relatively thin, with only a handful of small LDT units observed this week, largely regional general cargo vessels displaced from war-affected trading routes. The bigger question, when the wave of war-displaced tankers and bulkers that many expect to eventually head for recycling will actually materialise, remains stubbornly unanswered.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

MAKING PROGRESS!

Eid break.

Pakistan's waterfront observed Eid with three days of official holiday, March 21 through 23, and the week's reduced activity was therefore entirely expected rather than concerning. What is more notable is the underlying sentiment heading into the break, which is one of cautious optimism that represents a meaningful improvement from the despair that gripped Gadani for much of the past eighteen months.

Local steel plate prices held firm at USD 591.50/ton through the week, a remarkable steadiness in the context of regional turbulence, while the Pakistani Rupee held stable at PKR 279.15 against the U.S. Dollar, effectively flat week-on-week and representing a rare island of currency calm in a sea of depreciation across the sub-continent. For recyclers buying tonnage in dollars, this stability is a meaningful operational advantage.

Geopolitics.

The geopolitical dimension of the current conflict has, counterintuitively, presented Gadani with a modest opportunity. Regional tonnage owners, particularly those with tankers that were trading in Gulf waters and now find themselves either displaced or facing prohibitive war risk insurance, are beginning to consider Gadani as a potential end destination. Pakistan's geographic proximity to the Gulf, combined with yard availability and competitive pricing relative to Bangladesh, makes Gadani a plausible landing point for some of this stranded tonnage.

Al Hamza BV HKC!

Prime Green Recyclers, Pakistan's first HKC-certified yard along with Salams International and now this week, in further encouraging news, **Al Hamza Commodities as the first BV Class Certified HKC yard in Gadani**, continues to attract serious interest from owners who need a compliant South Asian alternative to Alang facilities. Additional Gadani yards are reportedly within two to three months of completing their own HKC upgrade journeys, a development that, when it materialises, will meaningfully expand Pakistan's addressable market for green demolition work.

Factions opposed to U.S. and Israeli actions in Iran have continued to demonstrate in major Pakistani cities, and isolated incidents near diplomatic facilities have been reported. These tensions add a layer of country risk that some international owners remain sensitive to, even where recycling yard operations themselves are unaffected. The situation bears monitoring as the conflict develops.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

QUEITISH!

TRY challenges.

Turkey had a brief/busy run, and now it is quiet again. After a period of surprising activity in the opening weeks of 2026, Aliağa has returned to a state of dormancy that has become familiar. Eid al-Fitr holidays, running from March 19 through 23, have provided convenient cover for what was already shaping up to be a subdued week, and no sales or significant enquiries were reported across the entirety of the period. The Turkish Lira continued its seemingly inexorable slide against the U.S. Dollar, trading at TRY 44.32 per Dollar this week, a fresh record low. While a weaker Lira theoretically makes Turkish steel more competitive in export markets, the domestic recycling sector operates primarily on local scrap economics, and a depreciating currency simply inflates the input costs that Aliağa yards face when bidding for international tonnage priced in dollars.

The Ege Çelik delisting from the EU's approved ship recycling facility register, which saw the yard removed following an inspection that cited insufficient pre-cleaning and the absence of an impermeable shoreline surface, continues to cast a shadow over Aliağa's regulatory credibility. While Ege Çelik has submitted corrective plans to the relevant authorities, the reputational damage of a public delisting is not easily repaired, and European owners considering Turkish yards for their EU-flagged vessels will need to satisfy themselves that alternatives on the approved list can absorb their requirements. Import steel prices at Aliağa continued their modest weekly corrections, with HMS 1&2 scrap edging lower by approximately USD 4/ton, reflecting both the holiday slowdown in purchasing activity and the broader uncertainty about steel demand in the construction sector that has been weighing on Turkish scrap economics since the start of Q1.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 12 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	450 / LDT	470 / LDT	480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Improving**	440 / LDT	460 / LDT	470 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *More than 97% of an end-of-life ship is reused, refurbished, or recycled, making ship recycling one of the best examples of a circular economy.*
- *More than 69 million tons of steel have been recovered from more than 8,800 ships recycled in Alang. With that much steel, about 9,500 Eiffel Towers can be built.*
- *When a ship is recycled, materials equivalent to about 5% of the ship's weight are directly reused, extending the life of valuable equipment and everyday items. Refurbished items can include chairs, fans, dishes, bathtubs, and commodes.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 21 – Eid-ul-Fitr March 26 – Ram Navami March 31 – Mahavir Jayanthi	March 18 – March 24 March 31 April 01 – April 06

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
March 20 to March 23 – Jumatul Bidah + Eid Day 2 & 3 March 26 – Independence Day	March 19 – March 22 April 1 – April 4

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
March 21 to March 23 – Eid-ul-Fitr Days 1, 2, & 3	March 19 to March 23 - Eid-ul-Fitr & Ramzan Bayrami

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ALANG - Port Position as of March 20, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Antar	3,676	General Cargo	*Delivered March 12*
2	BuzanSkiy	1,760	Reefer Cargo	*Delivered March 12*
3	Cita	8,715	Oil Tanker	*Delivered March 14*
4	Maya	10,129	Oil Tanker	*Delivered March 18*
Morality		***24,279***		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of March 20, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Smooth Sea	1,816	Tanker	*Delivered March 18*
		1,816		

GADANI - Port Position as of March 20, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Atlas	2,573	General Cargo	*Delivered March 16*
2	Lumoso Permai	7,628	Bulk Carrier	*Delivered March 16*
Total Tonnage		***10,201***		

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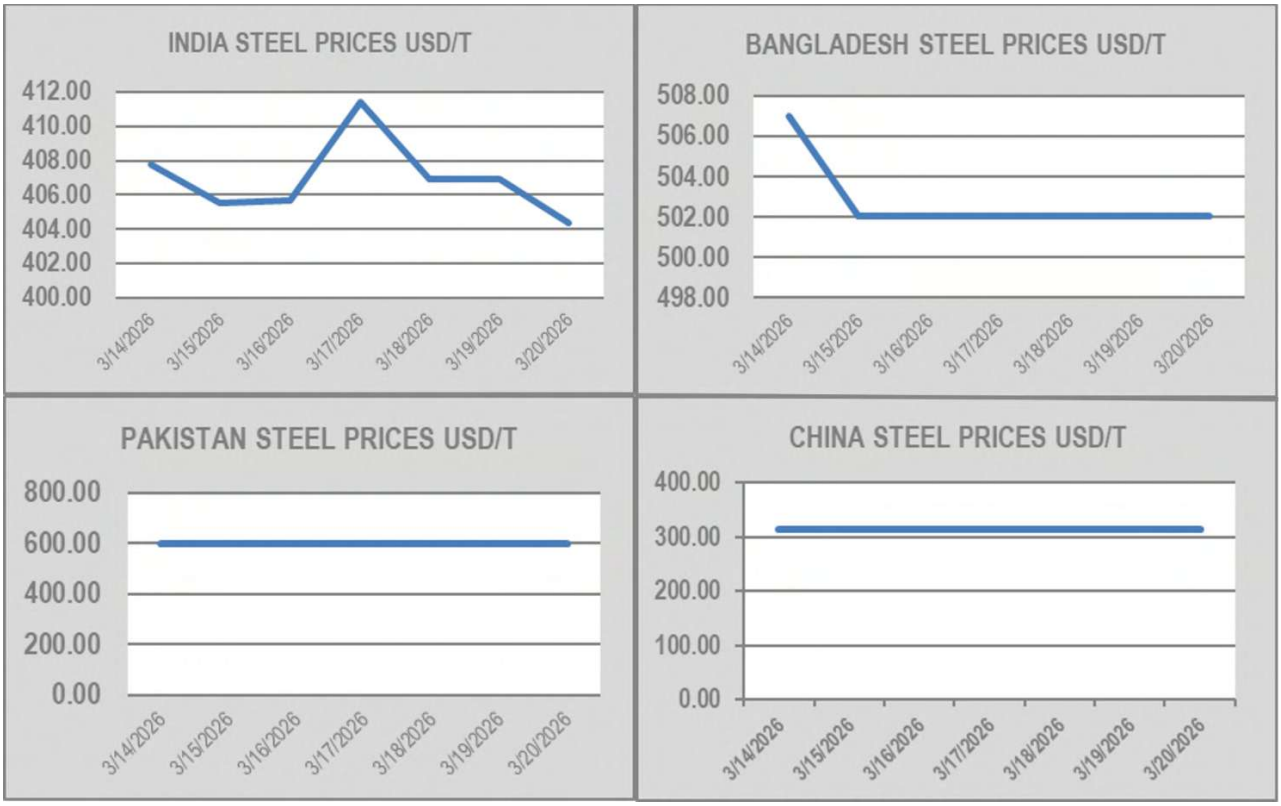
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
3/14/2026	407.79	37,700.00	598.72	168,000.00	506.98	61,000.00	314.15
3/15/2026	405.54	37,500.00	598.72	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/16/2026	405.71	37,500.00	598.72	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/17/2026	411.39	38,000.00	598.72	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/18/2026	406.91	37,700.00	598.72	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/19/2026	406.91	37,700.00	598.72	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/20/2026	404.38	37,700.00	598.72	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15



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